Japan Portfolio Brief — Thursday, October 29, 2026

Covers the Oct 28 close to the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Thu Oct 29. Positions are treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (same as prior runs):*** *page fetches (company IR, TDnet, DART, Kabutan, MOF, kabuyoho) failed, so everything comes from search-result summaries. Index-level numbers are reasonably sourced but conflict between outlets in places (flagged);* ***no company-specific news dated Oct 28–29 was found for most names****, so "QUIET" means "searched, nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are mostly aggregator-sourced and unconfirmed. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.*

---

1. Top of the stack

Samsung Electronics' record Q3 was a "sell the news" event: shares -4.1%, KOSPI -1.24% to 5,937.66, a day after SK hynix drove a +6.63% record. KOSPI gave up 6,000 after touching ~6,100 intraday (Fnnews, IBTimes AU); one outlet printed 5,847.61 (-2.7%), treated as an outlier (time.news). Samsung's final Q3: revenue ~₩195.3tn, operating profit ~₩107.4tn (slightly below ~₩107.7tn consensus), net profit ₩75.1tn, chips ₩106.5tn profit, HBM4 revenue more than tripled q/q and 2027 supply reported sold out (Investing.com). A ₩30tn Q3 cash dividend was paid but the rest of the ₩90–110tn 2026 return framework (₩60–80tn) is deferred to the January board; that deferral is what disappointed (SEDaily, News1, Hankyung). The stock closed at ₩232,000. **Book read-through:** Samsung C&T (Samsung stake value) is the direct link; contrast with SK hynix's immediate ₩60tn extra return.

SK hynix / SK Inc: the return-plan contrast. SK hynix Q3 (Oct 28): revenue ₩104.6tn, operating profit ₩83.33tn vs ~₩76–77tn consensus, 2026 shareholder returns ~₩100tn including a ₩20,000 Q3 dividend (₩10,000 special from the Kioxia gain); shares +10.89% to ₩1,487,000 on Oct 28 (eToday), then +2.2% to ~₩1,520,000 on Oct 29 (AJP; Google Finance snapshot differs) (Ajupress). **SK Inc (034730) was +10.95% to ₩552,000 at 11:07 on Oct 28** on stake value (Namdo News); full-day close and Oct 29 move not found. MATTERS.

Tokyo: Nikkei +1.1% to 64,659.47 on Advantest's forecast raise, TOPIX +0.3% to 4,003.28. Advantest (guidance raised after the Oct 28 close) supplied about two-thirds of the Nikkei gain; Tokyo Electron +2.4%, SoftBank Group +1.8% per this source (IBTimes AU). **Conflict:** an intraday item shows Nikkei +0.3% at 64,131, TOPIX -0.3%, TEL -0.9%, SoftBank -0.6% (rallies.ai) and Euronews had SoftBank -0.5% in the Asian session (Euronews). I treat the first as the close but **SoftBank's close is unverified**.

BoJ decision tomorrow (Fri Oct 30, ~noon JST) and the JGB position. Consensus: hold at 1.25% (Sept 18 hike passed 7–2), December hike expected; MUFG Research sees hikes in Dec 2026 and Apr 2027 (Business Today/Reuters, MUFG Research, Investinglive). **JGB No. 466 (JP1024661QB1) redeems Nov 1 — see Section 4.**

Fed (Oct 28): reported hold at 3.75–4.00%, 10–2 vote, with Cook and Hammack dissenting for a 25bp hike; Chair Warsh's press conference; tone on a December hike is read differently by Bloomberg and CNN (CNN, CNBC, Fox Business). Single-agent summary of search snippets; statement text not read. This resolves yesterday's "outcome not found" flag (and the range conflict, tentatively).

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **JGBs (Oct 29 secondary):** 5y 2.265% (unch), 10y 2.83% (+0.5bp), 30y 3.88% (+0.5bp); 2y not found. The 2y auction was Oct 29 with bid-to-cover 4.03 (vs 3.89 last month), described as strong; yield/tail not found (Business Today/Reuters). A stale Bloomberg page showed 10y 3.10%/30y 4.20%; conflicting, ignored. Cycle peak 2.97% on Sept 1 (carried from prior runs).

- **BoJ:** focus on the Outlook Report and "underlying inflation at 2%" language; no Outlook forecast numbers or explicit December probability found. A hawkish hold is mildly supportive for banks; a dovish surprise is the risk (our inference). Bank-sector reaction: nothing found.
- **Yen:** USD/JPY 157.50 at the Oct 26 close (ADB); buyers returned for a third day after a one-month low (FXStreet). No post-FOMC print and no intervention talk found.
- **Korea:** won closed ~1,336.8/USD (-0.9) (Nate); Bank of Korea held at 3.00% on Oct 22 with a hawkish bias; a November hike remains a debate; next meeting Nov 26 (carried from prior run); Oct CPI ~Nov 2 (unverified) (Blockmedia). KOSDAQ ~-2.34% to 753.23 (single report, low confidence).
- **Korea market structure:** nothing new. Commercial Act treasury-share cancellation mandate (passed Feb 25, 2026) remains the backdrop (Hankyung).

Megacaps / tech / electronics

- **Samsung, SK hynix, Advantest:** see Top of the stack.
- **Canon (7751):** the Oct 27 Q3 cut flag stands. Nine-month net income ¥246.4bn (+12.2%); the deck shows FY net income ¥333.0bn vs a ¥340.0bn comparison column and operating profit ¥456.0bn vs ¥465.0bn, which would imply a ~¥7bn net income trim; whether that column is the prior forecast is unconfirmed (Canon). Quarterly report due Oct 30. NOISE-to-MATTERS, not a thesis break.
- **Keyence (6861):** Q2 results were scheduled for Oct 29 after the close (ad-hoc-news); **no numbers found**. Baseline Q1: sales ¥346.6bn (+32.8%), operating profit ¥187.1bn (+44.7%) (JapanStockPulse). Reaction Oct 30 is the catalyst.
- **SoftBank Group (9984):** no company news; move conflicting (above). Q2 results confirmed **Nov 10**, 3:30pm JST (company notice) (SoftBank); SoftBank Corp reports Nov 9. OpenAI exposure $64.6bn for ~13% as of Oct 1; "harder credit market" commentary; the OpenAI-backed margin loan was cut from $10bn to as low as $6bn in May (TNW, ad-hoc-news). Alphabet's earnings disappointed overnight (Euronews); AI-trade sentiment risk.
- **Sony (6758):** QUIET; Q2 date disputed (Nov 5 vs Nov 9/10, none official).
- **SHIFT (3697):** NOISE; limit-up Oct 16 on profit outlook and a Tokyo Gas fund; ¥1,128 on Oct 27 (kabuyoho).
- **Seiko Epson, Omron, Optex, Oro, Appier, MegaChips, Sanken, RS Technologies:** QUIET; nothing found (Epson last news: Q1, FY attributable profit forecast ¥69.0bn (Simply Wall St)). Sanken/RS/MegaChips trade as AI-chain sentiment names, so the Advantest/Samsung split is the read-through.
- **NAVER (035420):** QUIET; Q3 listed Nov 11, 16:00 by a single calendar (KnowingAsset); previous run's preview pointed to a miss.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575):** NOISE; Oct 7 Q3 prelim operating profit ₩781.8bn (+13.5% y/y) missed consensus by ~24% (Newstomato).

Banks / financials / real estate

- **Fidea (8713), Kita-Nippon (8551), Kyoto FG (5844), MUFG (8306), Resona (8308), Shimizu Bank (8364), SMTG (8309), SBI (8473), Japan Post (6178):** all QUIET today; BoJ Oct 30 is the sector event. Interim dates (kabuyoho, unconfirmed): SBI **Nov 2**; Resona **Nov 10**; Kita-Nippon and SMTG **Nov 12**; MUFG, Kyoto FG, Fidea, Japan Post **Nov 13** (kabuyoho MUFG); Shimizu likely early Nov (last year Nov 7) (Monex). Reference prints: SMTG Q1 recurring profit ¥173.4bn (2.1x), FY net ¥380bn (kabuyoho); Shimizu Q1 ¥2.25bn vs ¥2.4bn interim forecast (Monex); Kita-Nippon FY ordinary profit forecast ¥6.6bn (+4.1%) (kabuyoho). Prices: Fidea ¥2,483 (Oct 14), SBI ¥2,964 (Oct 22), Japan Post ¥2,342.5 (Oct 23).
- **Mitsui Fudosan (8801), TOC (8841), Katakura (3001), Tokyotokeiba (9672), Yakult (2267), Shochiku (9601):** QUIET. Mitsui Fudosan interim early Nov (previously Nov 6); TOC likely Nov 10–12; Katakura mid-Nov; Tokyotokeiba Nov 13 (IRBANK, unverified); Yakult Nov 13; Shochiku interim already out Oct 14.

Industrials / autos / materials

- **Honda (7267), Suzuki (7269), Subaru (7270):** QUIET. No guidance cut found for Suzuki (the prior run's Carview headline remains unverified; the index shows only an August Q1 upgrade) (Simply Wall St). Subaru Q1 operating profit -44% (Monoist); interim "early Nov" (last year Nov 10). Honda raised FY guidance in August.
- **JR Central (9022):** no Oct 2026 interim release found (last year Oct 29); **Keisei (9009):** interim Nov 6 per Matsui, "late Oct" per kabuyoho (Matsui). Check TDnet.
- **Daikin, Kubota, Hi-Lex, Sumitomo Metal Mining, Mitsubishi Materials, Nakayama Steel, Valqua, KH Neochem, Obara, Ebara Jitsugyo, Fudo Tetra, Tigers Polymer, JAPEX:** QUIET. Dates: Daikin ~Nov 5, Shibaura Machine ~Nov 4 (RTTNews, unconfirmed; not Shibaura Mechatronics 6590) (RTTNews), Nakayama Nov 5 (prior). Hi-Lex FY ends Oct 31.
- **Universal Entertainment (6425):** QUIET; no Q2 result found.

Korea single names

- **SK Inc (034730):** see Top of the stack. Q3 date not found (early–mid Nov, unverified).
- **Taekwang Industrial (003240):** MATTERS (live), no new item. Latest news Sept 15; Trustone's Sept 3 letter threatened an EGM request, books inspection and derivative suit; Taekwang filed a criminal complaint Sept 14 (SBS Biz, Bizwatch). **No DART access: EGM filing after Oct 3 neither confirmed nor ruled out.**
- **Amorepacific (002790):** Q3 date unknown (last year Nov 6; one source said Oct 29, not corroborated; no Oct 29 release found). Q2 baseline: revenue ~₩1.176tn, operating profit ~₩117bn (+59%).
- **LG Chem pref (051915):** Q3 Nov 5 (prior run; unconfirmed this run). The ~₩17.5bn operating-profit preview vs ₩537bn consensus from the last run remains unverified.
- **Samsung C&T (028260):** QUIET; Q3 calendar entry Oct 22 with no figures found.
- **F&F, LG Corp, Hyosung, ILJIN, LS Corp, SK Discovery, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss, Daewon Sanup, Eusu:** QUIET; searched, nothing found. Q3 deadline ~Nov 16.

3. Probably noise

- **SoftBank -0.5%/-0.6% vs +1.8%** — intraday vs close; resolve before any call.
- **KOSPI 5,847.61 (-2.7%)** — outlier print; close was 5,937.66.
- **Stale Bloomberg JGB 10y 3.10% / 30y 4.20%** — conflicts with every dated source (2.83%/3.88%).
- **Samsung "-5%" midday headline** — close was -4.1%.
- **LG Electronics Q3 miss, SHIFT limit-up (Oct 16)** — pre-window.
- **Aggregator earnings dates generally**, especially Korean small caps.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB JP1024661QB1 — maturing Nov 1; decision needed before it redeems. JGB No. 466 (2-year, 0.50%, coupons May 1/Nov 1, issued 2024-11-01) redeems **2026-11-01** per MOF auction pages (MOF offer, MOF results, Nagoya SE). The ISIN→No. 466 mapping remains **inferred** (a direct ISIN search returned nothing; neighbouring JGB ISINs follow a similar pattern, e.g. JP1024561Q15 for No. 456). Nov 1 is a Sunday; payment Mon Nov 2 is the usual practice but **unverified** — confirm with the custodian. Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3. Reinvestment reference today: 5y 2.265%, 10y 2.83%, 30y 3.88%; 2y yield not found (auction strong). BoJ on Oct 30 is the key input. `watchlist-japan.md` keeps the line until redemption is confirmed.

*Calendar (= aggregator/unconfirmed):**

- Oct 29 (after close): Keyence Q2*; JR Central*
- Oct 30: **BoJ decision** (~noon JST) + Outlook Report; Canon quarterly report; reaction to Keyence; Subaru* (unlikely, "early Nov")

- Oct 31: Hi-Lex FY-end
- Nov 2: SBI interim*; Korea Oct CPI*; JGB redemption/settlement (expected)
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed
- Nov 4–5: Shibaura Machine*, Daikin*, Nakayama Steel*, Valqua*; **LG Chem Q3** (Nov 5*); early-Nov cluster: Honda, Suzuki, Kubota, Mitsubishi Materials, KH Neochem, SMM, Ebara Jitsugyo, Sony (Nov 5–10 disputed), Amorepacific (early Nov*)
- Nov 6: Mitsui Fudosan*, Keisei*; US jobs report
- Nov 9–13: SoftBank Corp (9); **SoftBank Group (10, confirmed)**; Resona* (10); NAVER* (11); SMTG*, Kita-Nippon* (12); MUFG*, Kyoto FG*, Fidea*, Japan Post*, Yakult*, Tokyotokeiba* (13)
- Mid-Nov: Universal Entertainment, JAPEX, Obara, Appier, Optex, Oro, SK Inc; Korea small caps by Nov 16
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea

Undated-but-live: SoftBank margin-loan/OpenAI funding and AI-sentiment risk; Taekwang–Truston; Samsung January return decision (₩60–80tn); Suzuki possible guidance cut (unverified); yen intervention risk near 160; won weakness (~1,337).

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for owner, but narrowed.** 8524 = 北洋銀行, English name The North Pacific Bank (listed Prime/Sapporo; J-LIC), matching the owner's original wording. 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank (北日本銀行) (kabuyoho). No news or confirmed interim date for 8524 (expected ~Nov 13). Please confirm which is held; coverage continues on 8551.
2. **JGB:** maturity MOF-confirmed; ISIN mapping inferred; payment date unverified.
3. No other identity changes. Optex search surfaced only the US Optex Systems (wrong company); Samyang search risk remains (Samyang Holdings 000070 ≠ Samyang Tongsang 002170).

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm ISIN→No. 466 and Nov 2 payment with the custodian; reinvestment plan relative to the Oct 30 BoJ outcome and 2y/5y quotes.
- **Samsung C&T / SK Inc:** how much of the Samsung deferral vs SK hynix ₩100tn return divergence is in each NAV discount? SK Inc's close on Oct 28–29?
- **SoftBank (9984):** Oct 29 close; current margin-loan LTV and collateral; any Q2 (Nov 10) preannouncement of OpenAI marks.
- **Keyence (6861):** Q2 numbers released after the Oct 29 close and guidance.
- **Canon (7751):** confirm the ¥333.0bn vs ¥340.0bn FY net income revision.
- **Advantest / Tokyo chips:** do Samsung's deferral and Alphabet's miss cap the AI-chain bid tomorrow?
- **Taekwang (003240):** DART check for any EGM/books-inspection filing after Oct 3.
- **JR Central, Keisei, Subaru, Suzuki:** TDnet check for Oct 28–30 releases; Suzuki guidance.
- **MUFG (8306):** confirm interim date (Nov 13 looks late vs usual early-Nov pattern).
- **Fed:** read the statement text and the Warsh press conference; confirm 3.75–4.00% and the December signal.
- **Names with no news in 4+ runs:** Ubiquoss, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Katakura, TOC — fetch DART/EDINET directly (network allowlist for kabuyoho, DART, TDnet would fix this).